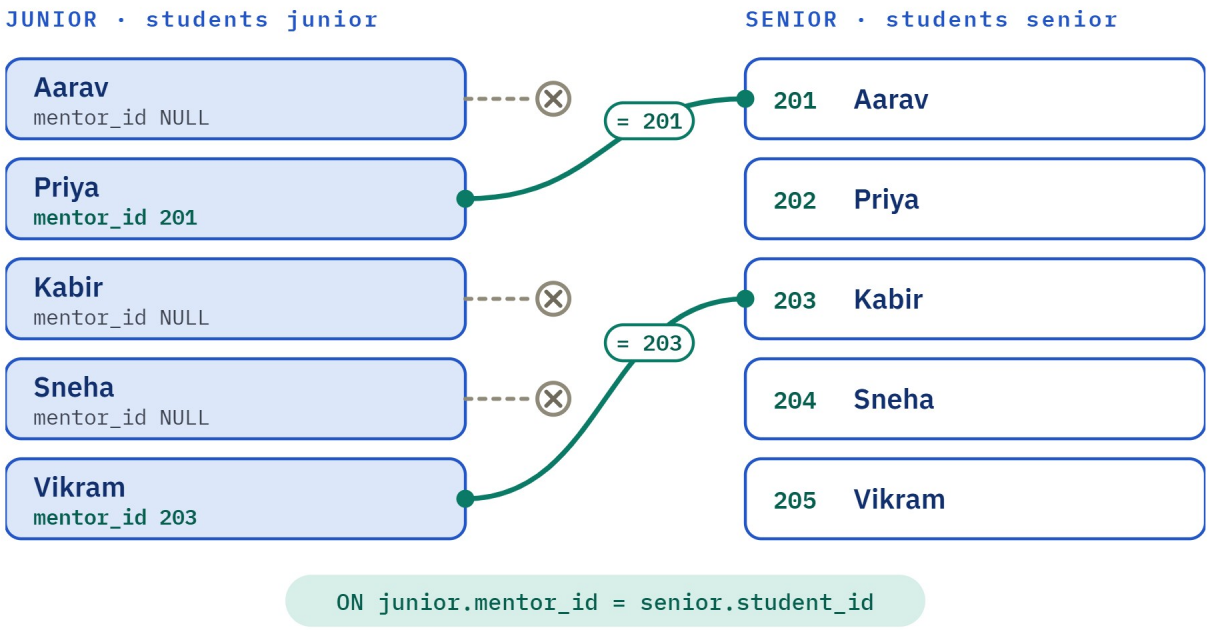
Same table twice, and shortcuts.

Not new join types: a join where both sides are one table, and two ways to type less.

SELF JOIN · ONE TABLE, TWO HATS (ALIASES)



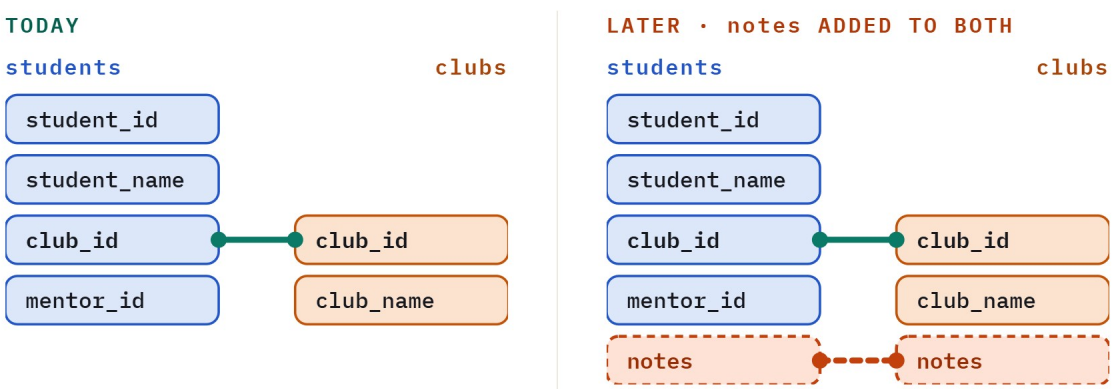
Who mentors whom? Mentor and mentee both live in **students**.

```
SELECT junior.student_name AS student,
       senior.student_name AS mentor
FROM students junior
LEFT JOIN students senior
  ON junior.mentor_id = senior.student_id;
```

STUDENT	MENTOR
Aarav	NULL
Priya	**Aarav**
Kabir	NULL
Sneha	NULL
Vikram	**Kabir**

LEFT JOIN, not INNER, so students with no mentor still appear.

NATURAL JOIN · LINKS EVERY SAME-NAMED COLUMN



One shared name, one link: same as **ON club_id**. Result: Aarav, Priya, Kabir, Vikram.

A coincidental name becomes a second link. **Same SQL, different rows**: matches vanish unless notes also agree.

THREE WAYS TO WRITE THE SAME INNER JOIN

ON — explicit · default

```
JOIN clubs c ON s.club_id = c.club_id
```

USING — you name the column

```
JOIN clubs USING (club_id)
```

`s.club_id` + `c.club_id` → merged into one **club_id**

NATURAL — implicit · throwaway only

```
NATURAL JOIN clubs
```